

Duration: 40 minutes

Full Marks: 60

Read the following passage and answer the questions below it:

We human beings tend to forget how far we have come as a species in a relatively short period of time. It was only in the 1870s when we had the first house that was lighted with electricity. Cars just started to become available 100 years ago. Charles Lindbergh made the first trans-Atlantic flight in 1927. Televisions didn't become widely available until after World War II. In other words, the advances humankind has made in a relatively short period of time have been nothing short of extraordinary. Perhaps just as extraordinary is how we tend to simply adapt to these incredible changes, not realising how completely our world has been altered in a short span of time. With that in mind, it is worth looking back at some of the amazing scientific advances we have made in the last few decades.

1. Using the following words, make your own sentences:

2X5=10

a) Species; b) Extraordinary; c) Adapt; d) Incredible; e) Decades

2. Answer the following questions:

2X5=10

- a) When did we get electricity?
- b) When did car become available?
- c) Who made the first trans-Atlantic flight?
- d) What technological advancement did happen after World War II?
- e) Can you mention some mention-worthy inventions in the last 100 years?

3. Choose the correct answer:

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- i) What part of speech is "tend"?
a. noun b. verb c. adjective
- ii) The "trans" in the word "trans-Atlantic" is a ____
a. suffix b. syllable c. prefix
- iii) What is the verb form of "short"?
a. shorted b. enshort c. shorten
- iv) What type of noun is "Charles Lindbergh"?
a. proper b. common c. abstract
- v) What is the antonym of "available"?
a. proper b. common c. abstract

4. What is the correct Bangla translation of "In other words, the advances humankind has made in a relatively short period of time have been nothing short of extraordinary"?

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- a. অন্য কথায়, মানবজাতি তুলনামূলকভাবে স্বল্প সময়ের মধ্যে যে অগ্রগতি করেছে তা অসাধারণ কিছু ছিল না।
- b. অন্য শব্দে, মানবজাতি যে সামনে এগিয়ে গিয়েছে অনেক ছোট সময়ে, তা অসাধারণ ব্যাপার থেকে কোন অংশে ছোট নয়।
- c. অন্যভাবে বলতে গেলে, মানবজাতি অল্প সময়ে যে অগ্রগতি অর্জন করেছে, তা অসাধারণের থেকে কম কিছু না।

5. Write a short essay on any of the following topics:

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- a) An experience you will never forget b) Qualities of a best friend c) Your village home
- d) Uses and abuses of technology e) Benefits of reading literature

Admission Test
Summer 2019
Department of English
Varendra University

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[Answer all the questions. Marks for each question are shown in the margin.]

Read the following passage and answer the questions (1-7) below it:

Everyone has the right to education. Education shall be free, at least in the elementary and fundamental stages. Elementary education shall be compulsory. Technical and professional education shall be made generally available and higher education shall be equally accessible to all on the basis of merit. Education shall be directed to the full development of the human personality and to the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. It shall promote understanding, tolerance and friendship among all nations, racial or religious groups, and shall further the activities of the United Nations for the maintenance of peace. Learners have a prior right to choose the kind of education that shall be given to them.

1. What is the passage about? 4
2. Give a suitable title to the passage. 3
3. Identity the parts of speech of the underlined words in the passage. 1 x 4 = 4
4. Change the words as directed: 1 x 3 = 3
 - a) Free (into noun) b) education (into verb) c) respect (into adjective)
5. Write the meanings (either in English or in Bengali) of the words: 2 x 5 = 10
 - a) Right b) available c) merit d) peace e) tolerance
6. Make sentences of your own using the following words: 2 x 5 = 10
 - a) Choose b) elementary c) accessible d) development e) religious
7. Translate the following sentences into Bangla: 3 x 2 = 6
 - a) Everyone has the right to education. b) Elementary education is compulsory. c) Education promotes understanding, tolerance and friendship among all nations, racial or religious groups.
8. Write a short composition on any **one** of the following: 20
 - a) The Person You Admire Most
 - b) Your Strengths and Weaknesses as an Individual
 - c) Changes in Food Habit
 - d) Your Idea of a Good Person/Citizen
 - e) Any Recent Incident of Nationwide Importance